

guideline to 5 inches, and position the vertical guideline at 7 inches. Press [C] to switch to the Crop tool, and drag a rectangle of 5 by 7 inches. Move it to a suitable position, and double-click to crop; trying unusual shapes may be a good idea. For example, heart for a couple's photo. Cropping comes handy while correcting horizon lines or straightening your photos.

Automated Features

Improve the quality of your photographs by using the automated functions in Photoshop. Go to **Image > Adjustments > Auto Levels** and then apply Auto Contrast and Auto Color. Finally, sharpen them via **Filter > Sharpen > Sharpen**.

Sharpening

You can sharpen any image using Photoshop's Unsharp Mask filter (**Filter > Sharpen > 'Unsharp Mask...'**). This compensates for the blurring caused by the low-pass filter that is found in almost all digital cameras to improve image quality. Apply it before the image is re-sized, or resampled, but after other corrections have been done. Its ideal settings would be a radius value of 0.3 to 0.5, threshold value of 0 to 2 and amount between 200 to 500 per cent.

For compensating the blurring done by output process, it should be sharpened after resize/resample. Generally, finer the print, the lower will be the radius. For example, you will need a radius of 1.0 to 1.5 for photos that are printed on premium inkjet photo paper.



Use Photoshop's Unsharp Mask filter to sharpen your images